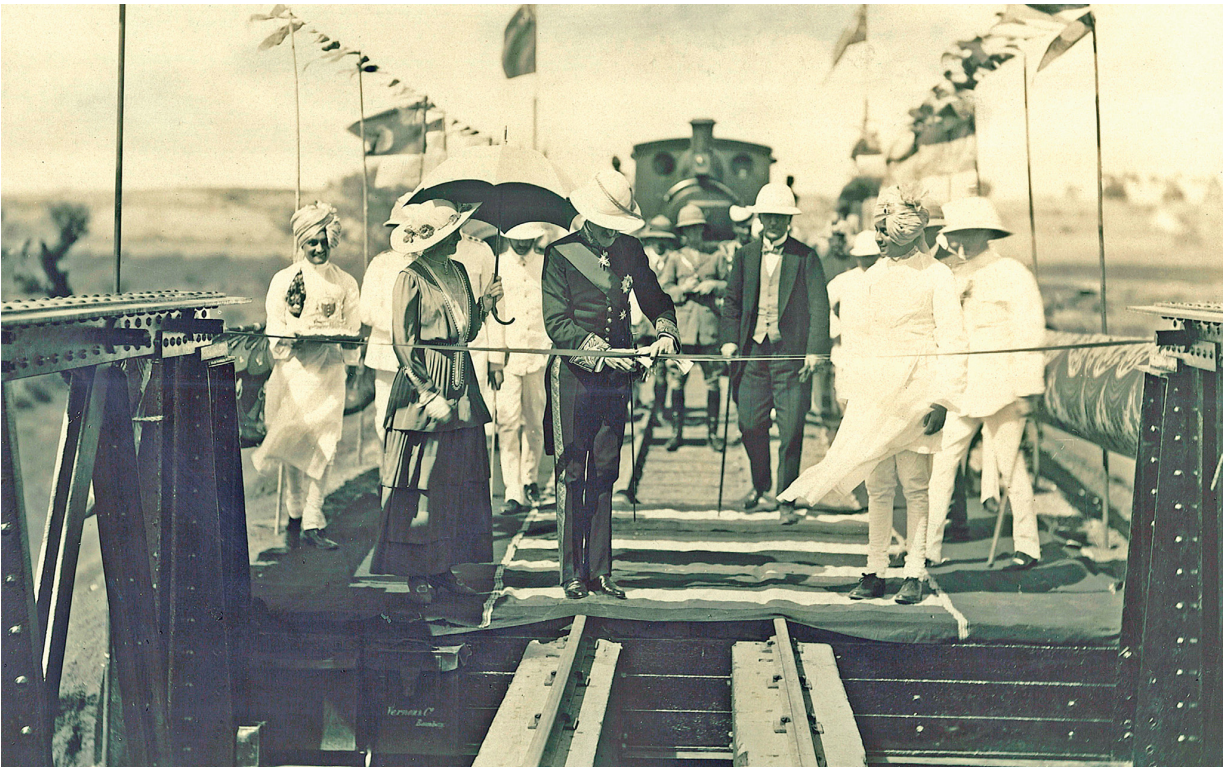


It was initially supposed to be a light tramway drawn by bullocks, but the line was repaired the following year. Bridges were strengthened, the stations built and staffed, and the line opened for use in April 1873. Through the 1880s, the Gaekwad paid the Government of India to build a series of light railway lines across his state connecting the towns with BB&CI railway stations. A workshop was built as well near Pratapnagar, Gujarat, to repair locomotives. The Nizam of Hyderabad and Maharaja Holkar of Indore, rulers of their respective States, followed suit with the former providing 1 million pounds sterling to build a line from Wadi on the Great Indian Peninsula Railway (GIPR) line to Hyderabad. This opened for traffic in October 1874.



▲ **Lord Willingdon**, Governor of Bombay (1913–19), cutting a ribbon on a railway bridge over River Karjan to inaugurate the Rajpipla Railway in Gujarat in 1917.

Connecting the heartland

Similarly, the British wanted to develop Central India, which had no railways at that time – GIPR and the East Indian Railway (EIR) ended at Khandwa (in present-day Madhya Pradesh) and Agra respectively.